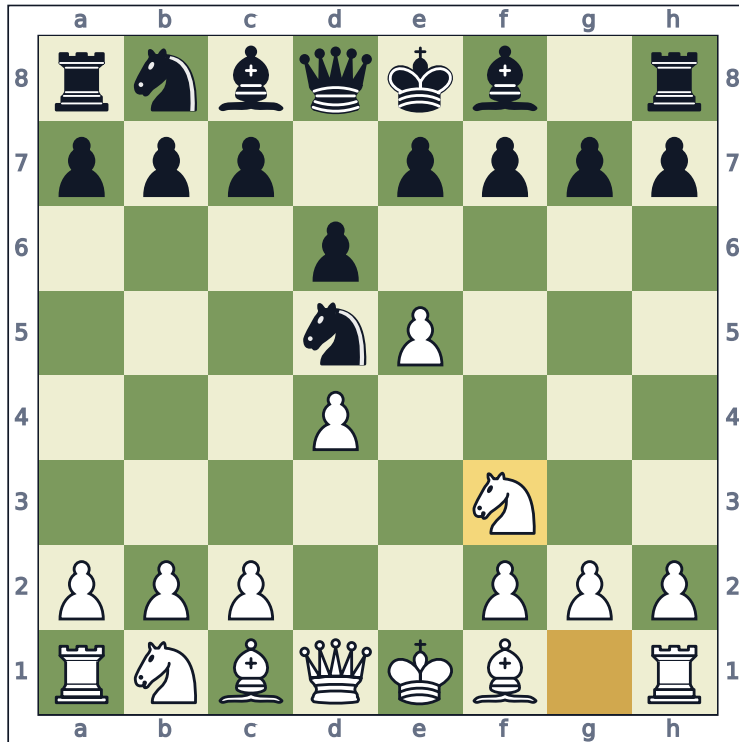


SEMI-OPEN AND UNCOMMON REPLIES TO 1.E4

Alekhine Defense

ECO B04 | 6 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Playable, but White has a meaningful objective edge. Black needs accurate counterplay.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.66 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

B04 covers Alekhine Defense. White claims central space while Black chooses a less common route to challenge it. The diagram uses the featured line Alekhine Defense: Modern Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. Nf3

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Occupy the center, develop with tempo when possible, and convert Black's unusual move order into a lead in activity.

BLACK'S GOALS

Attack the center rather than its edges, complete development, and prove the unusual setup has a concrete purpose.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

White often uses d4 or e5; Black needs a reliable ...d5, ...e5, or ...c5 challenge.

PIECE MAP

Central knights and active bishops matter more than early pawn hunting. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Do not assume an uncommon defense is bad. Refute moves with development and calculation, not impatience. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d6, White pawn on e5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Useful as surprise territory, though beginners should compare each line with a sound main defense.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B04 line

This section preserves all 6 names and defining routes assigned to B04 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Alekhine Defense: Modern Variation

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. Nf3

002 Alekhine Defense: Modern Variation, Albur Variation

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. Nf3 g6

003 Alekhine Defense: Modern Variation, Keres Variation

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. Nf3 g6 5. Bc4 Nb6 6. Bb3 Bg7 7. a4

004 Alekhine Defense: Modern Variation, Larsen Variation

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. Nf3 dxe5

005 Alekhine Defense: Modern Variation, Larsen-Haakert Variation

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. Nf3 Nc6

006 Alekhine Defense: Modern Variation, Schmid Variation

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. Nf3 Nb6